

Retail Sales Performance — Executive Summary

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Date: 05 August 2026

Headline Insight

Although overall sales performance is strong, profitability varies significantly across regions, product categories, and customer segments. The analysis indicates that higher discount levels are associated with reduced profitability, highlighting opportunities to improve pricing and discount strategies.

Key Findings

1. The **West** region generated the highest overall profit, while the **Central** region showed comparatively lower profitability.
2. The **Technology** category produced the highest overall profit, whereas the **Furniture** category generated lower profit despite strong sales performance.
3. Orders with higher discount levels were more likely to result in low or negative profit, suggesting that aggressive discounting has a significant impact on profitability.
4. The **Consumer** segment generated the highest sales volume, while the **Corporate** segment achieved stronger average profit margins.

Recommendations

- * Review discount policies, particularly for products receiving discounts above 30%, to improve overall profitability.
- * Prioritize marketing and inventory investment in high-performing categories such as **Technology**.
- * Investigate the underlying causes of lower profitability in underperforming regions and product categories.
- * Continue monitoring monthly sales trends to identify seasonal opportunities and support more effective inventory planning.

Methodology

This analysis was conducted using the **Superstore Sales** dataset containing approximately **9,994** retail sales records.

Tools Used

SQLite for SQL queries and data analysis

Microsoft Excel (Power Query, Pivot Tables, and formulas) for data cleaning and KPI analysis

Microsoft Power BI for interactive dashboard development and data visualization

The analysis focused on regional performance, product category profitability, customer segment performance, discount impact, and monthly sales trends to support data-driven business decision-making.